



Discussion Guide: Jacqui Lewis

“God-Talk for Hot-Mess Times”

Reflect

- Jacqui invites us to think of God as our dance partner. Have you envisioned God in this way before? How is this metaphor helpful for how you understand God and your own faith?
- In her opening story, Jacqui describes her family as “a people of the dance.” Reflecting on your family of origin or your chosen family, what would you describe them as “a people of”? What does this say about their values and experiences?
- Jacqui suggests that enslaved African Americans as well as activists throughout history have turned to dance (literally and metaphorically) in the face of hardship and injustice. In what sense is dance a form of resistance? How might it help build resilience and generate hope?

Respond

- Jacqui suggests that “we have a people problem because we have a God problem.” What does this “God problem” look like in your context, and how is it manifested?
- In your faith community what might it look like to “dance” with the knowledge that God trusts you to improvise? What sort of new dance steps might God be calling you to learn? What are the barriers to learning or using this new step?